

ation date later than the date of the last download.

Scheduling

Since Web site downloading can take considerable time, an offline browser can be set to shut down the PC once it is done.

WinHTTrack (www.httrack.com) and WebReaper (www.webreaper.net) and two capable offline browsers that offer almost similar features and functions. The former is more user-friendly.

WebRipper (webripper.dnsalias.com) is an offline browser that only downloads the non-HTML content of a site. It doesn't have a scheduler.

5.6 E-mail Clients

Offline e-mail clients reduce the time spent online, so people using a dial-up connection would find these applications useful. There are many ways to access remote email, of which POP and IMAP are the protocols popularly used. While POP (POP3 in its latest version) offers fewer features for mail management and is older than IMAP (IMAP4 in its latest version), it is more widely used. The most patent difference between these protocols is that POP3 usually deletes the emails from the server once they have been sent to the client, whereas IMAP doesn't. POP3 clients need to be configured to leave a copy on the server if the user prefers it that way. Most e-mail clients support both protocols. Features common to e-mail clients:

- Configurable e-mail display windows: The layout of the windows can be changed to suit the user's needs.
- Folders: Help categorise mails.
- Filters: Can be set to divert mails to folders based on their content and source.

5.6.1 Foxmail

(www.foxmail.com.cn/download.htm)

A capable mail client that shies from the spotlight. Foxmail 5 proved to be popular beyond its native shores—China. Yet, the latest version